

D642

Empathy and Inclusive Collaboration

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A hiring manager at a regional bank with 22 branches says she believes every candidate deserves an equal chance. Yet she consistently rates graduates of her own college higher without noticing she does it. The bank recently updated its website. This is best described as:

- A. Only a problem if the website states a hiring policy.
- B. Not bias, because she believes in equal chances.
- C. Explicit bias.
- D. Implicit bias (affinity toward people like herself).

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of explicit bias?

- A. A manager openly says he won't hire parents of young children because he thinks they're unreliable.
- B. A team uses the same structured questions for every candidate.
- C. A reviewer unknowingly scores résumés with certain names lower.
- D. A recruiter prefers candidates who share her hobbies without realizing it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A project lead at a software firm that sponsors a local marathon believes a new hire from a different industry won't adapt. Over three months he notes every mistake she makes but overlooks her two successful product launches. What bias is this?

- A. Confirmation bias
- B. Halo effect
- C. Affinity bias
- D. Recency bias

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A coworker at a warehouse that recently installed new conveyor belts tells you she feels overlooked because her ideas get ignored in team huddles. Your shift ends in ten minutes. Which response is most empathetic?

- A. "Just speak louder next time."
- B. "It sounds frustrating to have your ideas passed over. What happens in the huddles?"
- C. "Let's talk about how the new conveyor belts are working."
- D. "Everyone feels that way sometimes."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A team member at a design agency with a dog-friendly office shares that his parent was just diagnosed with a serious illness. Which response reflects empathy rather than sympathy?

- A. "At least they caught it early."
- B. "Bring your dog in; that always cheers people up."
- C. "I feel so sorry for you."
- D. "That sounds really hard. I'm here if you want to talk or need to shift your workload."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which description fits cognitive empathy specifically?

- A. Always agreeing with the other person's view.
- B. Feeling pity for someone from a distance.
- C. Understanding another person's thoughts and point of view, even without feeling their emotion.
- D. Feeling the same emotion the other person feels.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

On a product team at a toy company that just moved to a four-day workweek, junior members have stopped asking questions since a manager called one question “obvious.” The team hit its sales target this quarter. What most directly restores participation?

- A. Stop inviting junior members to meetings.
- B. Point to the sales target as proof the team is fine.
- C. The manager openly welcomes questions, thanks people who raise concerns, and admits his own mistakes.
- D. Require each member to speak for two minutes every meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A vice president at a hospital system that just opened a cancer center joins a brainstorming session with frontline nurses. As soon as she shares an idea, the nurses agree and stop offering their own. What best reduces the effect of power disparity?

- A. The VP invites nurses to share first and speaks last, or collects ideas anonymously.
- B. The VP presents her ideas first to set direction.
- C. Switch the discussion to the new cancer center.
- D. Power doesn’t matter as long as the VP is friendly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which behavior by a senior leader increases the effect of power disparity in a team discussion?

- A. Rotating who facilitates the meeting.
- B. Asking the newest member to speak first.
- C. Collecting ideas through an anonymous form.
- D. Announcing his preferred solution before asking the team for ideas.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A consumer-electronics company with a new headquarters has hired designers of many cultures, ages, and abilities. Yet all final product decisions are made by the same three senior engineers, and product ideas haven't changed. The company's stock rose 5% this year. What is missing?

- A. Nothing, since the stock price rose.
- B. Inclusion: the designers' perspectives aren't shaping decisions.
- C. More diversity hiring.
- D. Nothing; diverse teams innovate automatically.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team whose members have very similar backgrounds uses strong inclusion practices. What is its main limitation?

- A. Inclusion practices themselves cause groupthink.
- B. No limitation, because inclusion is enough.
- C. Fewer distinct perspectives to draw on, so blind spots may remain.
- D. The team will have too much conflict.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A team lead at a call center with 300 agents notices that a remote agent always keeps her camera off in meetings and assumes she is disengaged. The center recently won a customer-service award. What is the best next step?

- A. Note her as disengaged in her review.
- B. Privately ask the agent whether anything affects her camera use and how she prefers to participate.
- C. Mention the award to motivate her.
- D. Require cameras on for everyone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A hiring manager at a regional bank ~~with 22 branches~~ says she believes every candidate deserves an equal chance. Yet she consistently rates graduates of her own college higher without noticing she does it. ~~The bank recently updated its website.~~ This is best described as:

Target word: type of bias **Decides:** It happens without her awareness and against her stated values.

A	Camouflage	The website update has nothing to do with the bias.
B	Dropped element	Stated values don't rule out implicit bias.
C	Confusion set	Explicit bias is conscious and stated; she doesn't notice hers.
D	Correct	An automatic preference she isn't aware of.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which is an example of explicit bias?

Target word: find the conscious bias **Decides:** Openly stated preference.

A	Correct	A conscious, stated belief.
B	Adjacent category	That is a way to reduce bias, not a bias.
C	Inverted operation	Unaware bias is implicit.
D	Confusion set	Unnoticed affinity is implicit.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A project lead at a software firm ~~that sponsors a local marathon~~ believes a new hire from a different industry won't adapt. Over three months he notes every mistake she makes but overlooks her two successful product launches. What bias is this?

Target word: name the bias **Decides:** He notices only evidence that fits his belief.

A	Correct	Selective attention to evidence that confirms his view.
B	Inverted operation	Halo inflates judgments from one positive trait; this is negative and selective.
C	Confusion set	Affinity is favoring people like yourself.
D	Adjacent category	He ignores recent successes; the pattern is belief-driven, not time-driven.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A coworker at a warehouse ~~that recently installed new conveyor belts~~ tells you she feels overlooked because her ideas get ignored in team huddles. ~~Your shift ends in ten minutes.~~ Which response is most empathetic?

Target word: empathetic reply **Decides:** Reflect the feeling and invite more.

A	Dropped element	Skips listening and jumps to advice.
B	Correct	Reflects the feeling and invites her to say more.
C	Camouflage	Changes the subject to an irrelevant detail.
D	Adjacent category	Minimizes her experience.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A team member at a design agency ~~with a dog-friendly office~~ shares that his parent was just diagnosed with a serious illness. Which response reflects empathy rather than sympathy?

Target word: empathy vs. sympathy **Decides:** Staying with him, not pity or silver linings.

A	Inverted operation	A silver lining that minimizes the feeling.
B	Camouflage	Uses the office detail instead of engaging with him.
C	Confusion set	Pity from a distance is sympathy.
D	Correct	Acknowledges his experience and stays with him.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which description fits cognitive empathy specifically?

Target word: define cognitive empathy **Decides:** Understanding perspective, not sharing emotion.

A	Absolute language	Understanding a view is not the same as agreeing.
B	Adjacent category	That is sympathy.
C	Correct	Cognitive empathy is perspective-taking.
D	Confusion set	That is affective empathy.

7. Answer C Concept 5

On a product team at a toy company ~~that just moved to a four-day workweek~~, junior members have stopped asking questions since a manager called one question “obvious.” ~~The team hit its sales target this quarter.~~ What most directly restores participation?

Target word: restore psychological safety **Decides:** Fear of looking foolish after the manager’s reaction.

A	Inverted operation	Removes the voices the team needs.
B	Camouflage	Results don’t fix the silence.
C	Correct	Leaders’ visible behavior rebuilds safety to speak.
D	Absolute language	Forced speaking doesn’t remove the fear.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A vice president at a hospital system ~~that just opened a cancer center~~ joins a brainstorming session with frontline nurses. As soon as she shares an idea, the nurses agree and stop offering their own. What best reduces the effect of power disparity?

Target word: counter power effects **Decides:** The senior person’s ideas anchor the group.

A	Correct	Removes her ideas as the anchor.
B	Inverted operation	That is what caused the silence.
C	Camouflage	Changes topic without addressing the dynamic.
D	Dropped element	Friendliness doesn’t remove the power gap.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

Which behavior by a senior leader increases the effect of power disparity in a team discussion?

Target word: find the harmful behavior **Decides:** Leader signals the answer before others speak.

A	Adjacent category	That spreads influence rather than concentrating it.
B	Confusion set	That reduces power effects.
C	Inverted operation	That reduces power effects.
D	Correct	Anchors everyone to the leader's view.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A consumer-electronics company ~~with a new headquarters~~ has hired designers of many cultures, ages, and abilities. Yet all final product decisions are made by the same three senior engineers, and product ideas haven't changed. ~~The company's stock rose 5% this year.~~ What is missing?

Target word: diagnose the gap **Decides:** Diverse people are present, but decisions are closed.

A	Camouflage	Stock price doesn't show whether perspectives are used.
B	Correct	Diversity without inclusion doesn't change outcomes.
C	Adjacent category	The team is already diverse.
D	Absolute language	Diversity needs inclusion to produce new ideas.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A team whose members have very similar backgrounds uses strong inclusion practices. What is its main limitation?

Target word: reverse: inclusion without diversity **Decides:** Few distinct perspectives exist to include.

A	Inverted operation	Inclusion counters groupthink; sameness drives it.
B	Absolute language	Inclusion needs diverse views to add value.
C	Correct	Inclusion can only surface the views that are present.
D	Confusion set	Similar teams tend toward less conflict, not more.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A team lead at a call center ~~with 300 agents~~ notices that a remote agent always keeps her camera off in meetings and assumes she is disengaged. ~~The center recently won a customer service award.~~ What is the best next step?

Target word: respond to an assumption **Decides:** The lead is acting on an unverified assumption.

A	Dropped element	Acts on the assumption without checking it.
B	Correct	Seeks context before judging.
C	Camouflage	The award doesn't address the assumption.
D	Absolute language	A blanket rule without understanding the reason.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Implicit vs. explicit bias	Explicit bias is a conscious, stated preference; implicit bias is an automatic association that can contradict a person's stated values.	Believing good intentions rule out bias.	"Without noticing" vs. "openly says."
2	Confirmation bias	People notice and remember evidence that fits what they already believe and discount evidence that doesn't.	Mistaking it for the halo effect or affinity bias.	Someone tracks only the evidence that supports a prior belief.
3	Empathetic listening	Reflect the speaker's feelings and meaning, and invite more, before offering solutions.	Jumping to advice or minimizing.	Someone shares a frustration.
4	Empathy vs. sympathy	Empathy is understanding (cognitive) and sharing (affective) another's experience and staying with them; sympathy is feeling sorry from a distance.	Offering pity or "at least..." silver linings.	Choosing a response to someone's hardship.
5	Psychological safety	People speak up when leaders visibly welcome questions, thank dissent, and admit their own mistakes.	Forcing participation or pointing to results as proof all is well.	A team has gone quiet after a leader's reaction.
6	Power disparity	People with more power shape a discussion by speaking first; they should invite others' views first or use anonymous input.	Assuming friendliness cancels power.	A senior person joins a group of junior staff.
7	Diversity vs. inclusion	Diversity is the mix of people; inclusion is whether their perspectives actually shape decisions. Innovation needs both.	Assuming a diverse team automatically innovates.	A varied team where decisions stay with a few.
8	Seek context before judging	Ask privately about the situation before drawing conclusions from behavior.	Acting on an assumption or making a blanket rule.	"Assumes" or "concludes" about a colleague.

Course scope (public description): Empathy and Inclusive Collaboration guides students toward understanding the value and benefits of culturally diverse groups, identifying their own implicit and explicit biases, and applying strategies to overcome these biases. Students will learn to leverage diverse perspectives, ensure inclusivity, apply empathetic listening strategies, and build collaborative work groups. Students will learn that having multiple perspectives is imperative to being a creative and innovative problem-solver and developing inclusive solutions. Students will develop an awareness of power disparity, an ability to decentralize their own perspectives, and the knowledge of how to seek deeper context on issues rather than act through implicit bias.